

artificial intelligence finds itself in. The entire school of thought hasn't yet been unified, let alone have base principles, laws and theorems laid down.

Still, there are some schools of thoughts and practices that have received widespread nods of approval. While every single person working on AI might not agree with these, they are the most relevant approaches for anyone looking to understand the subject.

The two types of A.I.

Broadly speaking, there are two main branches of artificial intelligence: Strong AI and Weak AI. But the definitions of Strong AI and Weak AI are heavily dependent upon the philosophy of artificial intelligence. Are we trying to recreate an intelligent agent that can respond to a task by perceiving its environment? Or are we trying to recreate a mechanical equivalent of the human mind with all its complexities?

Let's take each of them individually to understand what they are all about.

- ▶ **Strong AI:** Every bit of science fiction you've read or seen – right from *Iron Man* to *Hitch Hiker's Guide to the Galaxy* – focuses on Strong AI. In essence, Strong AI is about building a machine that is capable of emulating the human mind to such an extent that it matches or exceeds it. As author and futurist Ray Kurzweil puts it, strong AI is machine intelligence with the full range of human intelligence.

Strong AI requires the intelligent agent to be able to think freely, or rather, outside the programming guidelines given to it. Of course, anyone reading this article will probably not be around by the time such technology comes into practical existence, but it's important to understand the goals of a science to know where it's headed and appreciate its present state.

This ability to think freely is what defines the human mind. The pinnacle of artificial intelligence would be emulating the human ability to not be bound by the predefined rules in our heads, question them and think beyond them.

- ▶ **Weak AI:** More actively in use today, Weak AI is a system that uses a set of pre-programmed rules to apply them to any task, to reach a successful fulfilment. Put simply, it's about a large and complex set of "if this, then that" rules of rationality.

While not as glamorous as Strong AI, the practicality of Weak AI is noticeable in several aspects of the world around us. And more impor-